

Overview

Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK) was launched in **2013** under the National Health Mission to provide comprehensive child health care. The programme focuses on the **early identification and intervention** of health conditions among children from birth to 18 years of age.

RBSK addresses the **4 Ds**:

- **Defects at birth**
- **Developmental Delays** including Disability
- **Deficiencies** (nutritional)
- **Diseases**

Eligibility

Who Can Benefit

- **All children aged 0 to 18 years**
- **No income limit** — universal coverage
- **No category restriction** — all children eligible
- **No documentation required** for screening

Age-Wise Screening Approach

Newborns (0–6 weeks)

- **Facility-based screening:** At public health facilities by ANMs, Medical Officers, and Gynaecologists
- **Community-based screening:** At home by ASHA workers

Children (6 weeks – 6 years)

- Screening at **Anganwadi Centres (AWCs)**
- Conducted by ANMs and Mobile Health Teams

Children (6–18 years)

- Screening at **Schools** under the School Health Programme
- Conducted by Mobile Health Teams

30 Identified Health Conditions

RBSK provides free screening, treatment, and management for **30 identified health conditions**, including:

Defects at Birth

- Cleft lip and palate
- Club foot
- Developmental dysplasia of hip

- Congenital cataract
- Congenital heart disease
- Neural tube defects
- Down syndrome

Developmental Delays & Disabilities

- Autism
- Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD)
- Cognitive Delay
- Neuro-motor Disorders
- Developmental Delay
- Speech and Language Delay
- Hearing Defects
- Vision Impairment
- Learning Disorder

Deficiencies

- Anemia
- Vitamin A deficiency
- Vitamin D deficiency
- Iron deficiency
- Malnutrition

Diseases

- Dental conditions
- Skin conditions
- Ear infections
- Refractive errors
- Otitis media
- Rheumatic heart disease

Benefits

1. **Free Health Screening** — At birth, Anganwadi centres, and schools
2. **Free Early Detection** — Identifying conditions before they become severe
3. **Free Treatment and Management** — Medicines, therapy, and follow-up
4. **Free Referral Services** — To District Early Intervention Centres (DEICs)
5. **Free Surgery** — For correctable conditions (where applicable)
6. **Disability Support** — Linkage to rehabilitation services
7. **Free Assistive Devices** — For children with disabilities

Documents Required

No specific documents required for screening. However, carrying the following is helpful:

1. **Aadhaar Card** (if available, for record linking)

2. **Birth Certificate** (for age verification)
3. **Previous medical records** (if any known condition)

How to Avail

For Newborns (0–6 weeks)

1. **At Birth:** Screening conducted at government hospital where baby is born
2. **At Home:** ASHA worker visits within 48 hours for community-based screening

For Children (6 weeks – 6 years)

1. **Visit Anganwadi Centre (AWC):** Regular health check-up days
2. **Mobile Health Team:** Visits villages for screening camps
3. **Get Screening Done:** Physical examination, developmental assessment, vision/hearing tests
4. **Referral if Needed:** Referred to District Early Intervention Centre (DEIC) for further evaluation

For School Children (6–18 years)

1. **School Health Programme:** Mobile Health Teams visit schools
2. **Screening Camp:** Conducted during school hours
3. **Health Card:** Updated with screening results
4. **Referral:** Children needing further care are referred to DEICs or higher facilities

For Treatment

1. **Visit DEIC:** District Early Intervention Centre for comprehensive evaluation
2. **Free Treatment Plan:** Developed by specialists
3. **Follow-up:** Regular monitoring and support

Important Notes

- RBSK is **completely free** at all government facilities
- No child can be denied screening due to lack of documents
- DEICs are established at district hospitals for comprehensive care
- Treatment includes both medical management and surgical intervention where needed
- Children detected with disabilities are linked to relevant social welfare schemes
- Parents should ensure children attend Anganwadi and school on health check-up days